Fiscal Year:	FY 2024	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 12/27/2023
PI Name:	O'Banion, Kerry M.D., Ph.D.		
Project Title:	Effect of Space Radiation on Innate Immune System Homeostasis Drives Immune and Endothelial Cell Dysfunction and Neurodegeneration		
Division Name:	Human Research		
Program/Discipline:			
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:			
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	(1) **SR**:Space Radiation		
Human Research Program Risks:	(1) **BMed**:Risk of Adverse Cognitive or Behavioral Conditions and Psychiatric Disorders (2) **Cardiovascular**:Risk of Cardiovascular Adaptations Contributing to Adverse Mission Performance and Health Outcomes (3) **Immune**:Risk of In Mission Impacts, Adverse Health Events or Long-Term Health Impacts due to Altered Immune Response		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
PI Email:	kerry_obanion@urmc.rochester.edu	**Fax:**	FY 585-756-5334
PI Organization Type:	UNIVERSITY	**Phone:**	585-275-5185
Organization Name:	University of Rochester		
PI Address 1:	Box 603		
PI Address 2:	601 Elmwood Ave		
PI Web Page:			
City:	Rochester	**State:**	NY
Zip Code:	14642-0001	**Congressional District:**	25
Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	2019-2020 HERO 80JSC019N0001-HHCBPSR, OMNIBUS2: Human Health Countermeasures, Behavioral Performance, and Space Radiation-Appendix C; Omnibus2-Appendix D
Start Date:	02/01/2021	**End Date:**	01/31/2025
No. of Post Docs:	0	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	0
No. of PhD Candidates:	1	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	0
No. of Master's Candidates:	0	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	0
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	0	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA JSC
Contact Monitor:	Zawaski, Janice	**Contact Phone:**	
Contact Email:	janice.zawaski@nasa.gov		
Flight Program:			
Flight Assignment:			
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:	No changes have been made		
COI Name (Institution):	Calvi, Laura M.D. (University of Rochester) Love, Tanzy Ph.D. (University of Rochester) Olschowka, John Ph.D. (University of Rochester) Williams, Jacqueline Ph.D. (University of Rochester)		

Grant/Contract No.:	80NSSC21K0542
Performance Goal No.:	
Performance Goal Text:	
Task Description:	The key objective of this proposal is to evaluate dose- and time-dependent effects of simulated space radiation on multiple tissue endpoints associated with normal aging. These endpoints include measures of the immune system, in particular those cells in the blood and tissues that represent a first line of defense for reacting to injury, the vascular compartment, another critical component of tissue homeostasis, and the brain, a critical system that shows age-associated degeneration which also occurs after radiation exposure. These studies will be carried out with male and female mice exposed to simulated space radiation at the NASA Space Radiation Laboratory using modern molecular techniques to measure tissue and cellular changes in gene and protein expression, alterations in cell phenotypes by flow cytometry, and behavioral tests and computer-assisted imaging in brain to quantify degenerative changes. This proposed work responds to Topic 6, Space Radiation and Tissue Homeostasis, in NASA's solicitation, and will provide key information about space radiation effects on the promotion of age-associated changes in multiple systems that are likely tied together in the etiology of late degenerative changes that may impact future astronaut health.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	Research focuses on mechanisms of normal tissue injury in brain and bone marrow following radiation exposure. Identification of specific pathways involved in late effect of radiation on these tissues may provide clues for protective or mitigating strategies in the setting of clinical radiotherapy or accidental radiation exposure.
Task Progress:	In this third year of the grant, we carried out irradiations during NASA Space Radiation Laboratory-22A (NSRL-22A) for our fourth proposed experiments, which treated mice with an NLRP3 inflammasome inhibitor after iron and galactic cosmic radiation (GCR) exposure. For this experiment, we irradiated 80 male and 80 female, 6-month-old C57BL/6 mice with 50 cGy 600 MeV/μ iron or 100 cGy simGCRsim BNL (20 mice of each sex in each group). An additional 80 (40 male, 40 female) mice were similarly processed at the NSRL (e.g., placed in holders for similar times), but not exposed to radiation. Following irradiation all mice were shipped back to Rochester and half of the mice were treated with 10 mg/kg MCC950 given by ip injection every other day for 1 month. The other half of the mice received ip saline injections every other day. All mice tolerated the drug and sham treatments. We carried out tissue collections from groups of these mice at 11 days post-irradiation (n=5, note that these mice received 4 injections of MCC950), and behavioral testing, followed by tissue collection at 6 months post-irradiation (n= 15). This last time point was completed in December 2023. Tissue and behavioral data analyses are in progress. We presented an abstract describing the overall goals of our project at The Human Research Program Investigators' Workshop (HRP IWS) in February 2023 and are preparing a manuscript describing our findings in the bone marrow compartment.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 01/07/2026)
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	O'Banion MK, Calvi LM, Olschowka JA, Love TMT, Williams JP. "Effects of space radiation on innate immune system homeostasis drives immune and endothelial cell dysfunction and neurodegeneration." 2023 NASA Human Research Program Investigators' Workshop, Galveston, Texas, February 7-9, 2023. Abstracts. 2023 NASA Human Research Program Investigators' Workshop, Galveston, Texas, February 7-9, 2023. , Feb-2023
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Hinkle JJ, Olshowka JA, Williams JP, O'Banion MK. "Pharmacologic manipulation of complement receptor 3 prevents dendritic spine loss and cognitive impairment after acute cranial radiation." Int J Rad Oncol Biol Phys. 2023 Dec 23. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijrobp.2023.12.017 , Dec-2023